Lab Action Guide

Copilot in Edge for Business Professionals

Version 2.0 (Optimised) · Updated March 2026

Duration	60 minutes core · Bonus tasks when time permits
Target Audience	Business professionals — no technical background required
Format	Three sections · 5–6 tasks each · Self-paced
Input Files	Meridian_Weekly_Notes.docx, Meridian_Release_Log.docx, Engineering_Notes.pdf, Strategic_Connections.html, Project_Financial_Projections.xlsx

How This Lab Works

In each section you open one input file directly in Microsoft Edge — just like opening a webpage. Once the file is open, Copilot can read what is on the page and answer questions about it.

Analysis workflow: Open file in Edge → Open Copilot sidebar → Ask short questions → Follow up

Writing workflow: Open file in Edge → Give Copilot a RIFCC prompt → Refine with follow-ups

★ COPY & PASTE INTO COPILOT

Main prompt — copy the entire block into Copilot.

▶ FOLLOW-UP — COPY & PASTE INTO COPILOT

Send this after the first response to extend or refine.

This guide covers three sections. Each section uses Copilot in Edge to work through a different type of real-world business task:

Section	What You're Doing	Time	Tasks
Section 1	Writing an executive communication **for weekly Highlights**	20 min	5 tasks
Section 2	Analysing a PDF product brief + an HTML market report	20 min	6 tasks
Section 3	Project Financial Projections — **Calcuate ROI on your product**	20 min	5 tasks
Bonus	Go deeper when time allows	+15 min	3 tasks

> Three scenarios run through this lab. Section 1 uses a scenario set at Meridian Analytics (a data products company). Section 2 uses a scenario set at a regional bank evaluating ClearSpend, a personal finance dashboard feature. Section 3 uses a scenario set at a software team calculating ROI on DevFlow, an internal CI/CD and developer tooling **product**. Each section is self-contained.

What You Will Need

Microsoft Edge browser with the Copilot sidebar available (icon in the top-right toolbar).

Input files for this lab:

File	Format / Used In
Meridian_Weekly_Notes.docx	Word document · Section 1
Meridian_Release_Log.docx	Word document · Section 1
Engineering_Notes.pdf	PDF · Section 2
Strategic_Connections.html	HTML · Section 2
Project_Financial_Projections.xlsx	Excel · Section 3

How to open the Copilot sidebar: Click the Copilot icon in the top-right corner of the Edge toolbar. The sidebar slides open on the right side while the document stays visible on the left.

How to open files in Edge: Press **Ctrl+O** (Windows) or **Cmd+O** (Mac) and browse to the file. Edge opens PDFs, HTML, and Word files natively. Once a file is open in your tab, Copilot can read it directly — no copying or pasting required.

■ Before You Start — Data Sensitivity Policy

All input files used in this lab contain fictional data created for training purposes only. This is intentional.

When you use Copilot in Edge in your real work, treat the following as a standing rule:

NEVER input into Copilot (or any AI tool):

- Real employee names, performance details, or HR-related content
- Unpublished financial figures, forecasts, or budget data
- Customer names, contact details, or any personally identifiable information (PII)
- Internal API endpoints, security patches, or vulnerability details
- Commercially sensitive strategy, M&A activity, or unreleased product plans

Why it matters: Copilot in Edge is processed through Microsoft's servers. Your organisation may have specific policies on what data may be submitted to cloud AI services. When in doubt, check with your IT or data governance team before using real documents.

In this lab: Every document, name, figure, and scenario is fictional. Use it freely — and carry this caution into your daily work.

Section 1: Writing an Executive Communication Summary

20 minutes

Your Scenario: You are a team lead at **Meridian Analytics**, a data products company. It is Friday afternoon, October 18, 2024. Your VP is waiting for the weekly executive highlight email before end of day. You have two input files — raw team notes and an engineering release log. You will use a staged prompting sequence to turn them into a polished, send-ready email.

Key rule for this section: Keep the **same Copilot conversation** running through all five tasks. Do not start a new conversation between tasks. Each task hands context to the next — the email draft in Task 1.5 draws on everything Copilot learned in Tasks 1.2, 1.3, and 1.4.

Task 1.1 — Set Up Your Input Files

1. Press **Ctrl+O** (Windows) or **Cmd+O** (Mac) in Edge and open **Inputs/Meridian_Weekly_Notes.docx**
2. Open the **Copilot sidebar** and start a **new conversation**

You are ready to begin. Copilot reads the document currently open in your tab — you do not need to copy or paste anything.

Task 1.2 — Extract the Key Stories

■ ■ Real-world caution — Team Notes

Weekly notes like these routinely contain employee names, performance concerns, budget figures, and unannounced decisions. In the real world, this type of document is internal and confidential. Before opening real team notes in any AI tool, confirm it is permitted under your organisation's data policy. The file used here is entirely fictional.

What you're doing: Before writing anything, identify what matters most from the raw notes. This is the thinking step — not drafting yet.

Make sure **Meridian_Weekly_Notes.docx** is open in your Edge tab. Copilot will read the document automatically. Start with the prompt below, then continue with the follow-ups:

★ COPY & PASTE INTO COPILOT

```
Summarize this document in 5 bullet points.
```

▶ FOLLOW-UP — COPY & PASTE INTO COPILOT

```
Which 3 points matter most to leadership?
```

▶ FOLLOW-UP — COPY & PASTE INTO COPILOT

```
Are there any risks or issues leadership should know about?
```

What to observe: Do you agree with Copilot's top story? If not, steer it — "I think the more important story is the Finance dashboard delay — can you adjust?" This is how you direct the AI rather than just accept its first answer.

Task 1.3 — Translate the Release Notes

■ ■ Real-world caution — Engineering Release Logs

Release logs often reference internal API endpoints, details of security fixes, unpatched vulnerabilities, and unreleased features. Sharing this content with an external AI service could expose your infrastructure or violate your organisation's security policies. Always use anonymised or fictional versions when practising — as this lab does.

What you're doing: Turn the engineering release log — written for developers — into plain-language highlights a VP would understand.

Open **Inputs/Meridian_Release_Log.docx** in a new Edge tab (Ctrl+O / Cmd+O). Copilot will read the document now open in your tab. Continue in the **same Copilot conversation** and start with the prompt below, then continue with the follow-ups:

★ COPY & PASTE INTO COPILOT

```
Summarize the key updates in this release log.
```

▶ FOLLOW-UP — COPY & PASTE INTO COPILOT

```
Which of these updates matter most to the business (not engineers)?
```

▶ FOLLOW-UP — COPY & PASTE INTO COPILOT

```
Rewrite these in simple, non-technical language and flag any risks.
```

What to observe: Did Copilot flag the CSV endpoint deprecation as a risk? About 40 customers still use it — leadership needs to know a comms plan is required before December 31. If Copilot missed it, push: "What about the legacy CSV endpoint being retired — is that worth flagging?"

Task 1.4 — Business Impact Reflection

What you're doing: Before writing the email, use Copilot to surface the business value behind the week's work. This gives you the concrete impact details — milestones, who benefited, and value delivered — that will make the executive email far more specific and credible.

Continue in the **same Copilot conversation**.

Step 1 — Milestone:

```
What milestone was achieved based on this work?
```

▶ **FOLLOW-UP — COPY & PASTE INTO COPILOT**

```
Make this more specific and business-relevant.
```

Step 2 — Business Units:

★ **COPY & PASTE INTO COPILOT**

```
Who (which business units) benefited from this work?
```

▶ **FOLLOW-UP — COPY & PASTE INTO COPILOT**

```
Explain briefly how each business unit benefits.
```

Step 3 — Value Delivered:

★ **COPY & PASTE INTO COPILOT**

```
What value was delivered (time saved, risk reduced, efficiency gained, cost savings)?
```

▶ **FOLLOW-UP — COPY & PASTE INTO COPILOT**

```
Quantify the value where possible (e.g., hours saved, % improvement, cost impact).
```

> **What to observe:** These three steps give you the "so what" that turns a status update into a business case. Keep the answers in view — you will pull them directly into the email in the next task.

Task 1.5 — Write the Executive Email

What you're doing: Use everything Copilot has built — the highlights, release notes, and business impact reflection — to write the final send-ready email. No additional pasting needed — Copilot already has the full context.

Continue in the **same Copilot conversation**:

```
Using the insights from the weekly notes, release log, and the
business impact reflection we just completed, write a weekly
executive update email.

Include:
- A clear subject line with the week ending date (Oct 18, 2024)
- A short opening summary (2-3 sentences)
- 3-5 key highlights
- What we shipped (in simple business language)
- Business impact (the milestone achieved, which business units
  benefited, and the value delivered — use the specific details
  from our reflection)
- Key risks or watch items (be direct)
- Next steps for the coming week

Audience: VP-level, non-technical
Tone: Professional, concise, easy to scan
Length: Under 300 words
```

▶ FOLLOW-UP — COPY & PASTE INTO COPILOT (only if needed)

```
Make this more concise and ensure the biggest risk is clearly highlighted.
```

What to observe: Read the full draft before moving on. Is the Finance dashboard delay in the Watch items, mentioned honestly? Does the subject line match the top story you identified in Task 1.2? The business impact section should reference specific milestones and value figures — not generic statements. The full transformation happened in five structured prompts, each building on the one before.

Before You Move On — Section 1 Checks

- Subject line matches the most important story of the week
- Finance dashboard delay is mentioned honestly in Watch items — not softened
- CSV endpoint risk is flagged (comms plan needed before Dec 31 sunset)
- Business impact section includes specific milestones, business units, and quantified value
- AI-isms removed — "In today's rapidly evolving landscape...", "It is worth noting that..."
- You would genuinely send this to your VP as written

■ Key Takeaway

A single "write me an email" prompt produces a generic result. The extract → translate → reflect → draft sequence gives Copilot exactly what it needs at each step — and gives you natural checkpoints to steer the output before it becomes the wrong thing done well.

Section 2: Analysing Documents — PDF and HTML

20 minutes

Your Scenario: You are a Product Manager at a regional bank evaluating a new feature called **ClearSpend** — a personal finance dashboard that helps customers track spending, set budgets, and work toward savings goals. You will work through two documents: a product brief (PDF) and a market research report (HTML).

Start a new Copilot conversation for Section 2. The Meridian Analytics context from Section 1 is no longer relevant here.

■ ■ Real-world caution — Product Documents and Market Research

Product briefs, roadmaps, and market research reports frequently contain commercially sensitive strategy, unreleased feature plans, or proprietary competitive intelligence. Customer-facing data — such as user research, NPS scores, or any content tied to real customer identities — should never be submitted to an AI tool without appropriate data handling approval. The documents used in this section are fictional.

Task 2.1 — Open the Product Brief and Get Oriented

Open the following file in Microsoft Edge: **Inputs/Engineering_Notes.pdf**

Click the **Copilot icon** to open the sidebar. Then ask three quick questions to orient yourself — do not read the document first, let Copilot do it:

★ COPY & PASTE INTO COPILOT

```
Summarize this page in 4 bullet points
```

▶ FOLLOW-UP — COPY & PASTE INTO COPILOT

```
What problem is this feature solving for customers?
```

▶ FOLLOW-UP — COPY & PASTE INTO COPILOT

```
What are the main risks or concerns mentioned?
```

What to observe: Each question is one sentence. Notice how the third question — shifting from "what is this" to "what could go wrong" — changes the type of answer you get. Short, specific questions consistently outperform long, vague ones for document analysis.

You will now use a structured prompt pattern — **RIFCC** — to draft a professional email to your team.

RIFCC stands for: **Role · Input · Format · Constraints · Checks.** It gives Copilot the five things it needs to produce a usable professional document instead of a generic one. Copy and paste this prompt:

★ COPY & PASTE INTO COPILOT

```
Role: You are a Product Manager at a regional bank writing to your immediate team.

Input: The ClearSpend product brief on this page.

Format:
Write a professional email announcing that ClearSpend has been approved for
development and that the team will be kicking off this quarter.

- Subject line
- Opening paragraph (2 sentences — what it is and why it matters)
- Three bullet points covering: the key customer benefit, the timeline,
  and the biggest challenge to watch
- One-sentence closing with a clear next step

Constraints: Under 150 words total. Professional but warm tone. Do not mention
specific cost figures. No technical jargon.
```

▶ FOLLOW-UP — COPY & PASTE INTO COPILOT

```
The tone is a little flat. Make it sound more energised — this is genuinely
exciting news for the team. Keep the same structure.
```

> **What to observe:** The RIFCC prompt gave you a well-structured draft. The follow-up adjusted the tone without rebuilding the structure. Get the structure right first, then tune the voice — that is the efficient pattern.

Task 2.3 — Write an Executive Summary with Format Variations

Now write a one-page executive summary for bank leadership. You will produce two format variations and choose the better one.

Version 1 — Bullet Format:

★ **COPY & PASTE INTO COPILOT**

```
Role: You are a Product Manager preparing a briefing document for the
bank's executive leadership team.

Input: The ClearSpend product brief on this page.

 Format:Write a one-page executive summary of the ClearSpend feature.

- Section 1 -- What We Are Building: 2 sentences
- Section 2 -- Why This Matters: 3 bullet points on customer and business value
- Section 3 -- Key Risks: 3 bullet points ordered from highest to lowest severity
- Section 4 -- Recommended Next Step: 1 sentence

Constraints: Under 200 words total. Business language only -- no technical terms.
Every point must be grounded in the product brief on this page.
```

▶ **FOLLOW-UP — COPY & PASTE INTO COPILOT**

```
Rewrite the same executive summary as short paragraphs instead of bullet points.
Same four sections, same content — just flowing prose. Same word limit.
```

> **What to observe:** Which version is easier to scan? Which feels more authoritative? Generating both takes seconds — choosing between them is your editorial judgment.

Task 2.4 — Switch to the Market Research Report

Close the PDF tab. Open the following file in a new Edge tab: **Inputs/Strategic_Connections.html**

This is a formatted HTML market research report — it opens like a proper webpage with sections, tables, and visual design. Open the **Copilot sidebar** and ask these questions to get the big picture:

★ **COPY & PASTE INTO COPILOT**

```
What are the top 3 trends in this report?
```

▶ **FOLLOW-UP — COPY & PASTE INTO COPILOT**

```
Which of these trends is most directly relevant to a bank launching
a personal finance dashboard?
```

▶ **FOLLOW-UP — COPY & PASTE INTO COPILOT**

```
Based on this report, if our bank launches a personal finance dashboard
in Q1 2027, are we early, on time, or late to the market?
```

> **What to observe:** The second prompt added context — "a bank launching a personal finance dashboard." That one addition made the answer more specific and actionable. Adding your situation to

Task 2.5 — Find the Numbers and Verify with Citations

Market research reports are valuable for the specific data they contain. Ask Copilot to surface it:

★ COPY & PASTE INTO COPILOT

```
What statistics or data points in this report support investing in
a personal finance dashboard right now?
```

▶ FOLLOW-UP — COPY & PASTE INTO COPILOT

```
What does the report say customers expect from their bank's digital
products in 2026?
```

Tip: Try it now: click a citation and confirm the highlighted text matches what Copilot told you.

What to observe: When you see citation links, use them — a 15-second check confirms whether Copilot is quoting the document or synthesising. When you do not see them, Copilot may be inferring rather than citing directly. Build this check into any output that includes a number you plan to use in a meeting.

Task 2.6 — Write a Risk Briefing with a Structured Table

Now produce a risk briefing document your VP could act on immediately.

★ COPY & PASTE INTO COPILOT

```
Role: You are a Risk Analyst preparing a briefing for the VP of Digital Banking.

Input: The 2026 Digital Banking & Fintech Innovation Report on this page.

Task: Create a risk register for launching a personal finance dashboard
at a regional bank.

Format:
- One-sentence introduction stating the purpose of this document
- A table with these columns: Risk | Severity (High / Medium / Low) |
  Business Impact | Recommended Action
- Table rows ordered from highest severity to lowest
- One closing sentence naming the single most urgent action to take

Constraints: Include only risks explicitly mentioned in this report.
Maximum 6 rows. Plain business language -- no jargon.
```

▶ FOLLOW-UP — COPY & PASTE INTO COPILOT

```
Add a fourth column to the table: Timeline (Immediate / Short-term /
Long-term) -- when each risk needs to be addressed. Keep the severity ordering.
```

What to observe: "Order the table from highest severity to lowest" is one instruction that turns a list into a prioritised view. The format instruction is often where most of the practical value in a RIFCC prompt comes from.

Before You Move On — Section 2 Checks

- Verified at least one statistic from the risk briefing against the source using a citation link
- The risk table severity order reflects your actual business judgment — not just what Copilot decided
- AI-isms and filler phrases removed from the team email and executive summary
- Both documents pass the test: "Would I send this to my VP as written?"

■ Key Takeaway

Short questions extract information. RIFCC prompts produce documents. Knowing which mode to use — and switching between them — is the core practical skill. The format and constraints in a RIFCC prompt are where most of the quality difference comes from.

Section 3: Project Financial Projections — Calculating ROI on your Product 20 minutes

Your Scenario: You are an engineer who owns **DevFlow** — an internal CI/CD and developer tooling **product** your team built and launched six months ago. Engineering leadership has asked you to present an ROI case at the next quarterly review. Cloud and API costs have been climbing month over month, and you need to show whether the **Product** is still worth the investment — and what needs to change if it is.

Start a new Copilot conversation for Section 3. You will be supplying key figures directly in your prompts, since Excel does not render in Edge the same way HTML and PDFs do.

■ Strong caution — Financial Data

This section involves typing financial figures directly into Copilot prompts. In the real world, this is one of the highest-risk things you can do with an AI tool. Financial projections, investment amounts, ROI figures, and cost data are typically confidential, material to business decisions, and often subject to legal or regulatory restrictions — especially in industries like banking, finance, or publicly listed companies.

Do not use real figures from your organisation's financial systems, budget tools, or internal planning documents in any AI prompt unless your organisation has explicitly approved it and the tool is deployed in a compliant, data-protected environment.

The numbers in this section are entirely fictional and exist only for practice.

Task 3.1 — Open the ROI Workbook

Open the following file: **Inputs/Project_Financial_Projections.xlsx**

This is a formatted Excel workbook with four sheets:

- Executive Summary — total investment, ROI, payback period, and budget variance flags
- Cost Breakdown — month-by-month infrastructure and API cost trend (Jan–Oct 2024)
- ROI & Projections — productivity value model, ROI scenarios, and 3-year forecast
- Risk Register — six engineering risks ordered by severity

Spend **2 minutes** navigating all four sheets. Note the colour coding: red = over budget or failing a criterion, green = on track. You do not need to read every number — just orient yourself before you start asking questions.

Tip: If you have Microsoft 365 Copilot in Excel: you can ask questions directly in the Excel interface instead of switching to Edge. Use whichever is available to you.

Open the **Executive Summary** sheet and pull the key figures into Copilot:

★ COPY & PASTE INTO COPILOT

```
I'm an engineer reviewing the ROI of an internal developer product
called DevFlow. Here are the key figures from the Executive Summary:
total investment to date $412,000, annual productivity value (Year 1)
$707,000, Year 1 ROI 125%, payback period 7 months post-launch.

Monthly run costs have drifted: infrastructure started at $8,200/month
and is now $15,400/month; API costs started at $3,500/month and are
now $6,800/month. Total monthly run cost is $22,200 against a budget
of $11,700.

Can you summarise what these numbers tell me -- is this product
delivering a strong ROI, and what is the main thing threatening it?
```

▶ FOLLOW-UP — COPY & PASTE INTO COPILOT

```
The API cost variance alone is +$3,300 per month. What does that mean
on an annual basis, and how much does it reduce the Year 1 ROI if it
is not resolved?
```

▶ FOLLOW-UP — COPY & PASTE INTO COPILOT

```
The ROI model shows 3 scenarios: optimistic (API costs resolved,
95% developer adoption) at 173% ROI and 6-month payback; base case
(current trajectory) at 125% ROI and 7-month payback; conservative
(costs continue rising, adoption stalls) at 82% ROI and 11-month payback.

Which scenario is most likely given the cost data, and what single
change would have the biggest positive impact on ROI?
```

> **What to observe:** You are supplying the data rather than letting Copilot read the file directly — this is the standard workflow for Excel. The quality of the analysis depends entirely on which numbers you choose to include. Omitting the API cost drift would have made the **product** look healthier than it is.

Task 3.3 — Identify What Could Go Wrong

Open the **Risk Register** sheet and review the six risks. Then ask:

```
I have a risk register with 6 items for our internal developer product.
The top 3 are:
API cost overrun (High severity, High likelihood) -- +$3,300/month over
budget, reduces Year 1 ROI by ~18 percentage points if unresolved;
Security patching backlog (High severity, High likelihood) -- 3 unpatched
CVEs in pipeline dependencies, compliance audit risk;
Vendor lock-in -- two core integrations (High severity, Medium likelihood)
-- no fallback if the CI orchestration API or artefact store goes down.

What does it mean that two of the top three risks are High/High --
and what should I tackle first?
```

▶ **FOLLOW-UP — COPY & PASTE INTO COPILOT**

```
If none of these three risks is resolved before the Q4 engineering review,
what is the realistic impact on the ROI case I need to present to
leadership -- and which risk damages it the most?
```

> **What to observe:** You are asking Copilot to reason about consequences, not just summarise. This is where AI analysis adds real value beyond reading — working through implications from the inputs you provided. Verify any specific figure Copilot cites against the actual spreadsheet before using it in a meeting.

Task 3.4 — The Verification Test

What is hallucination? AI models sometimes produce confident-sounding information that is not accurate — including inventing data that was never in the source. This is called hallucination. It is not intentional, but in a technical or business context it can be costly.

Type the following into Copilot **exactly as written**:

★ **COPY & PASTE INTO COPILOT**

```
The ROI workbook references an industry benchmark showing that internal
developer products typically achieve 200% ROI in Year 1, based on the
2025 Gartner Developer Productivity Survey. Does our DevFlow result of
125% fall short of that benchmark?
```

Stop. That benchmark and that survey do not exist. You invented them. Now watch how Copilot responds.

What a correct response looks like:

> "I don't see that benchmark in the data you've shared. The Gartner Developer Productivity Survey you mentioned hasn't been referenced in any of the figures provided."

Gartner survey as real, or builds an analysis comparing DevFlow's ROI against it.

Record in a note:

- What did Copilot say?
- Did it push back correctly, or agree with the fabricated premise?
- Honest assessment: would you have caught this in a real situation without deliberately testing for it?

> **What to observe:** This is not a one-off exercise — it is the habit to build. Before any Copilot-generated number goes into a document you will share, ask: "Is this actually in the source, or did Copilot add it?"

Task 3.5 — Write the Engineering ROI Summary

Bring together everything from this session to produce a formal summary your engineering manager or VP Engineering could act on.

★ COPY & PASTE INTO COPILOT

```
Role: You are a software engineer preparing a formal ROI summary for
an internal product you own, presented to your VP of Engineering.

Input: The DevFlow ROI data we have discussed -- total investment $412,000,
Year 1 ROI 125%, productivity value $707,000/year, monthly cost overrun
+$10,500 vs budget, and three high-severity risks (API cost overrun,
security patching backlog, vendor lock-in).

Task: Write a one-page ROI summary recommending whether to continue
investing in DevFlow or re-evaluate the product strategy.

Format:
- Header: To, From, Date, Re (one line each)
- Executive Summary: 2 sentences stating the recommendation clearly
- ROI Highlights: 4 bullet points -- the numbers that make the case
- Cost Concerns: 3 bullet points on the budget drift and its impact
- Risk Summary: table with columns -- Risk | Severity | ROI Impact |
  Recommended Action -- ordered High to Low
- Recommendation: 3 sentences -- state the recommendation, the primary
  condition that must be met, and the consequence of inaction

Constraints: Under 350 words excluding the table. Direct, engineering
tone -- acknowledge both the ROI delivered and the real risks to it.
Label any assumptions clearly as ASSUMPTION:.
Only use figures from the data provided.
```

▶ FOLLOW-UP — COPY & PASTE INTO COPILOT

```
Rewrite the same recommendation as a concise briefing note in bullet
points only. No paragraphs, no table -- clean numbered bullets an
engineering manager could read in 60 seconds.
Same recommendation, same key figures. Under 150 words.
```

What to observe: Two formats, same content — the memo goes in a formal email or quarterly review deck; the bullet version goes in a Slack message or meeting pre-read. Copilot produces both in under a minute. Choosing which to use is your judgment.

Before You Move On — Section 3 Checks

- Every figure in the ROI summary traces back to the spreadsheet — no invented numbers
- The recommendation is consistent with the data: if two out of three top risks are High/High, the summary should reflect that honestly
- Language is precise: "Year 1 ROI is 125% under the base-case scenario" — not "the product has a 125% ROI"
- You would put your name on this summary and defend every figure in it

■ Key Takeaway

Excel requires a different workflow — you bring the key figures to Copilot rather than letting it read the file. The hallucination test is not a gotcha exercise: it is a live demonstration of a real risk that affects real decisions. The verification habit is what separates responsible AI use from reckless AI use.

Bonus Tasks — Complete When Time Allows

> Complete these in order when time allows. They are not required — but each one covers a capability you will use in real work. Aim to complete at least one.

Bonus Task B.1 — Write a Go/No-Go Decision Summary

Still in your Section 3 Copilot conversation, produce a structured decision table for a product review meeting:

★ COPY & PASTE INTO COPILOT

```
Role: You are preparing a go/no-go decision summary for a product
review meeting.

Input: The DevFlow ROI data and risk profile from this session.

Task: Write a structured go/no-go decision summary for continuing
to invest in DevFlow.

Format:
A table with four columns:
- Decision Factor
- Category (Financial / Compliance / Operational / Strategic)
- Status (Green / Amber / Red)
- One-line Assessment

Include 8 factors total. After the table, write two sentences:
- Sentence 1: The overall go/no-go signal based on the balance of
  Green, Amber, Red
- Sentence 2: The single most important condition that must be
  resolved before a "Go" decision is final

Constraints: Base all assessments on the data discussed. Plain
language in the Assessment column -- one sentence anyone in the
room can understand.
```

> **What to observe:** Organising the same information by category (Financial, Compliance, Operational, Strategic) maps to how executives actually think about project risk. The RAG status gives an instant visual read. Check the statuses honestly — did Copilot skew toward "Go"?

Bonus Task B.2 — Compare the Compose Tab to a RIFCC Prompt

Copilot in Edge has two writing modes. Most people only use one. This task shows you when each is the right tool.

Compose tab in the Copilot sidebar (next to Chat). Set: Tone: Enthusiastic · Format: Blog post · Length: Medium. Type: "Announce the ClearSpend feature launch to bank employees" and click Generate.

Step 2 — Use a RIFCC prompt for the same task (in the Chat tab):

★ COPY & PASTE INTO COPILOT

```
Role: You are writing for the bank's internal employee newsletter.
Your audience is the entire company -- not just the product or tech team.

Input: The ClearSpend product brief on this page.

Task: Write a short, engaging blog post announcing ClearSpend to the whole company.

Format:
- A catchy headline -- something a person would actually want to read
- Two-sentence introduction that hooks the reader
- Three short paragraphs: what it does, what it means for customers,
  what it means for the bank
- One closing sentence inviting colleagues to share the news

Constraints: Under 250 words. Conversational and enthusiastic. No financial figures.
```

▶ FOLLOW-UP — COPY & PASTE INTO COPILOT

```
The headline is too corporate. Give me 3 alternative headline options --
one customer-focused, one team achievement, one future-looking.
```

> **What to observe:** The Compose tab is faster for simple, tone-based drafts. The RIFCC prompt gives you precise control over structure, audience, and constraints. The RIFCC output is almost always more specific and more usable — at the cost of 60 extra seconds to write the prompt. Know which to reach for based on the stakes of the output.

Bonus Task B.3 — Analyse a Video with Copilot

Copilot in Edge can summarise and analyse video content playing in your browser — one of its most underused capabilities.

Step 1: Open YouTube in a new Edge tab. Search for one of:

- "fintech personal finance app demo 2025" — a competitor product walkthrough
- "digital banking innovation 2026" — a conference presentation
- "Microsoft Copilot in Edge demo" — a walkthrough of the tool you are using right now

Choose a video 5–15 minutes long.

Step 2: Let it play for 60–90 seconds, then ask Copilot:

```
Summarize the key points made in this video so far
```

Step 3: Once you have skimmed or watched the full video:

★ **COPY & PASTE INTO COPILOT**

```
Based on this video, what are 3 features or capabilities that ClearSpend
does not currently offer -- based on what you know of the ClearSpend brief?
```

> **Tip:** If Copilot has lost the ClearSpend context, add it briefly: "ClearSpend is a personal finance dashboard for a regional bank: spending breakdown, budget tracking, savings goals, spending alerts."

Step 4:

▶ **FOLLOW-UP — COPY & PASTE INTO COPILOT**

```
What is the single most compelling thing in this video that our bank
should consider adding to the ClearSpend roadmap?
```

> **What to observe:** Copilot processes captions, narration, and on-screen text. You did not take notes. This works for conference talks, vendor demos, competitor announcements, and training videos. Quality depends on caption availability — a video with no captions gives Copilot very little to work with.

Key Takeaways

Stage your prompts for complex writing.
"Write me an email from these notes" produces a generic result. Extract → translate → reflect → draft produces a document you would actually send. The stages take minutes and produce a measurably better outcome.

Short questions for analysis. RIFCC prompts for documents.
One-sentence questions are the fastest way to find information in a document. RIFCC prompts are the right tool when you need a professional output. Knowing which mode to use — and switching between them in the same session — is the core practical skill this lab builds.

The format instruction is where most of the quality comes from.
"Write a summary" and "Write a summary as a table ordered by severity" produce entirely different results. Adding structure to your format request — tables, ordered lists, headers, word limits — is consistently the highest-value change you can make to any writing prompt.

Always verify numbers before using them.
Before any specific figure from a Copilot response goes into something you will share, confirm it in the source. The hallucination test in Section 3 is not a one-off exercise — it is a habit that applies to every piece of data Copilot surfaces.

Follow-up prompts are where the quality happens.
Your first prompt is a starting point. Adjusting the tone, adding a column, requesting a second format, asking for three headline variations — these follow-ups are where Copilot produces something you would actually use. Think of the first prompt as a rough draft, not a finished product.

Protect data as a default — not an afterthought.
Every prompt you send to Copilot is processed by an external service. Before using Copilot on a real document, ask: does this file contain employee data, customer information, unpublished financials, or security details? If yes, check your organisation's AI usage policy before proceeding. The habit to build is simple: fictional or anonymised data in AI tools, real data only where the policy explicitly allows it.

Quick Prompt Reference

Save these for use after the lab. Copy and adapt them to your own work.

The Weekly Executive Email Sequence (Section 1 condensed)

Step 1 — Extract: (Open your weekly notes file in Edge, then ask:)

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```
I have raw team notes in the document open in this tab.
List the top 3 highlights, any risks, and the single most important
story this week. 1-2 sentences each. Do not write the email yet.
```

Step 2 — Translate: (Open the engineering release log in Edge, same conversation:)

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```
The engineering release log is now in the document open in this tab.
Pick the 3 most business-relevant items, rewrite in plain language,
and flag any risks requiring communication action.
```

Step 3 — Draft:

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```
Write a weekly executive highlight email using everything we've discussed.
Structure: subject line, opening summary, key highlights, what we shipped,
watch items, next week preview.
Audience: VP-level. Tone: Direct. Length: under 300 words.
```

Step 4 — Personalise:

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```
Add a human opening line and a sign-off inviting questions.
Give me the complete final version signed as: [NAME], [ROLE]
```

The Meeting Prep Prompt

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```
I have [X] minutes before a meeting about [topic].
Give me: 1) the 3 most important things to know, 2) one question I
should ask, 3) one risk I should be ready to address.
Under 150 words.
```

The Risk Spotter

```
Review the document on this page. Identify: the top 3 risks or problems
I should know about, any commitments or deadlines easy to miss,
and one question I should ask before proceeding.
Be direct. Under 150 words.
```

The Product ROI Check (Section 3 condensed)

Step 1 — Assess ROI:

★ COPY & PASTE INTO COPILOT

```
I own [Product NAME]. Key figures: total investment $[X],
Year 1 ROI [X]%, payback [X] months, monthly run cost $[X] vs budget $[X].
Is this product delivering strong ROI, and what is the main
thing threatening it?
```

Step 2 — Stress-test with scenarios:

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```
ROI scenarios: optimistic [X]%, base case [X]%, conservative [X]%.
Which is most likely given the cost data, and what single change
would have the biggest positive impact?
```

Step 3 — Reason about risks:

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```
Top 3 risks: [Risk A] (High/High), [Risk B] (High/High), [Risk C] (High/Medium).
If none is resolved before [DEADLINE], what is the realistic
impact on the ROI case and which risk damages it most?
```

The Verification Check

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```
Look only at the document on this page. For each fact or number
in your previous response: does it appear in this document?
(Yes / No / Partially). Flag anything I should not rely on.
Do not add new information.
```